FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-31-17002

Issue Title : MAX Displays System (MDS) Blockpoint 1 Software Improvements

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3165-00	-8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
03/28/2017	10/25/2017	10/20/2017
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Updated to reflect Service Letter and Service Bulletin release.

Applicability

All 737MAX Airplanes prior to Line Number 6464 (first 30 737MAX deliveries). Applicable until incorporation of the reference MDS Operational Program Software (OPS) Blockpoint (BP) 1 Service Bulletin (SB) 737-31-1752.

Description

Boeing has identified multiple issues with the current MDS OPS that will require changes in the software.

The following conditions may be seen in service for the affected airplanes.

1. Navigation Display (ND) Approach Mode will be inoperative until MDS BP 1 incorporation.

2. Inverted Voltage Input Statuses on the MDS Maintenance Pages for "FIRE HANDLE L (R)" and "ENG START SWITCH CONT L (R)".

3. Momentary Nuisance "TERR RANGE DISAGREE" Flag on the Vertical Situation Display (VSD) when switching from PLAN mode to MAP mode.

4. The PFD/MFD switch readout on the MDS Maintenance Page in the OMF displays "INBD" when there is no data present.

Background

During the 737MAX Flight Test program, Boeing found the noted issues that require a software fix. The software fixes will not be implemented prior to the first 737MAX delivery. This prompted the certification of a new software update for the MDS.

For condition 1, it was found that during ILS, GLS, localizer or backcourse approaches the lateral deviation pointer shown on the ND Approach Mode has a reversed polarity and displays an incorrect indication compared to the PFD. Therefore, Boeing determined the function unusable. The ND Approach mode is a carry over feature from the 737 Classic and is not used often for

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operation on 737NG. It is brought up on the Navigation Display by selecting the "APP" mode on the EFIS Control Panel. It is only used as an aid during landing and is not required for safe operation. All information displayed in the ND Approach Mode is available on the PFD.

For condition 2, in the Onboard Maintenance Function (OMF) the voltage readout is displayed for multiple inputs to the Display Processing Computer (DPC). Four of the voltage statuses are inverted such that it shows 'VOLT' when there is 0 voltage and 'OPEN' when voltage is actually present. The 4 statuses affected are "FIRE HANDLE L (R)" and "ENG START SWITCH CONT L (R)". The MDS maintenance pages are a new function on the 737MAX where the voltage status of the input pins to the DPC are displayed. The new functionality is used in troubleshooting procedures for maintenance messages.

For condition 3, the "TERR RANGE DISAGREE" flag will show on the VSD for up to 3 seconds only after a specific set of actions. This will occur when switching from PLAN mode to MAP mode and then selecting VSD on the EFIS CP. If VSD is already selected, the nuisance flag sometimes displays. This flag will extinguish on its own and does not cause any maintenance message or status message. Therefore Boeing considers this flag to be a nuisance.

For condition 4, in the OMF MDS maintenance pages, the status of the positions of the switches and buttons in the displays system are displayed. For the PFD/MFD switch, "INBD" indicates that the PFD is being displayed on the Inboard Display and that the outboard display is blanked. The readout should be blank if there is no data.

Status

All conditions will be fixed in the MDS Blockpoint 1 OPS update. Boeing has coordinated with Rockwell Collins and have committed a new MDS Blockpoint software release set for production incorporation on L/N 6464. Retrofit Service Bulletin 737-31-1752 release is targeted for September 2017.

For condition 1, the ND Approach Mode feature will be inoperative until MDS BP 1 incorporation due to the incorrect indication. The "APP Mode" on the EFIS CP will have an INOP sticker placed over it. Additionally, the reference Operations Manual Bulletin (OMB) titled "Navigation Display - Approach Mode" has been released instructing flight crews to not use that mode.

For condition 2, there are references in the Interactive Fault Isolation Manual (IFIM) to the inverted voltage input statuses for specific troubleshooting procedures. For the affected airplanes being delivered before incorporation of MDS BP 1, the IFIM has been updated to reflect the inverted indication.

For condition 3 and 4. There is no impact to any maintenance documents and no change in action is needed. The issues will be fixed in the software update.

Interim Action

Operators are to review the reference OMB titled "Navigation Display - Approach Mode" and not use the ND Approach Mode until MDS BP 1 incorporation.

Final Action

Operators to review the reference Service Letter 737-SL-31-064 released October 2017.

Operators to incorporate the Service Bulletin 737-31-1752 MDS OPS BP 1 software update released October 2017.

Upon incorporation Boeing reminds operators to submit a Service Bulletin Incorporation (SBI) through MyBoeingFleet for all documents to be updated accordingly.

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Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-31-1752		
Operations Manual Bulletin (OMB)	"Navigation Display - Approach Mode"		
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-31-064		

Related Categories

- New Equipment : Information on new parts available now or soon to be introduced

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